PARTICIPANT HANDBOOK

HACKTOBERFEST HACK DAY BENGALURU

AWS STUDENT BUILDER GROUP AT ATRIA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

DATE

Friday, October 23, 2026

Be at the venue before 8:15 AM · registration opens 8:30 AM IST

VENUE

Atria Institute of Technology

1st Main Road, AGS Colony, Anandnagar, Hebbal, Bengaluru 560024

COST

Free of charge

Open to all university & college students

POWERED BY

MLH MAJOR LEAGUE HACKING × DEV

PRESENTING PARTNER

DigitalOcean

INSIDE THIS HANDBOOK

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Read it the night before, or keep it in your pocket on the day. Every page stands on its own.

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New to open source? Start at page 03. You do not need experience — dedicated mentors will guide you through Git commands, finding good first issues, and submitting clean pull requests. Solo builders and teams of up to four are equally welcome. Full challenge briefs live on the MLH challenges page at **page 09**.

STEP ZERO

BEFORE YOU ARRIVE.

This event is open to all university and college students, whether you are a beginner writing your first lines of code or an experienced open-source contributor. There is no registration fee — you get the hack day, workshops, mentor guidance, refreshments and swags for free.

WHO CAN ATTEND

All university and college students. Beginners and experienced contributors are both welcome.

TEAM SIZE

Solo or in teams of up to 4 members. No team yet? Find one during the morning team formation session.

WHAT IT COSTS

Nothing. No fee, and food and attendee kits are covered while supplies last.

BE THERE BEFORE 8:15 AM

Registration opens at **8:30 AM**, so arrive at the venue **before 8:15 AM**. You need time to check in and be seated before the inauguration at 9:30.

TEAMS CHECK IN TOGETHER

If you are building as a team, **every member must be present** at the desk at the same time. Check in as a group — we cannot admit a team member-wise.

YOUR WRISTBAND

Every participant gets a wristband at check-in. It is the **only** proof you are part of this Hack Day.

KEEP YOUR WRISTBAND ON

Wear it for the entire day. It is how we identify participants, and **without it you will not be considered for any activity during the Hack Day** — no prizes, no food, no recognition. If it falls off or breaks, get it replaced at the registration desk straight away.

ATTENDEE CHECKLIST — TICK THESE OFF

- [ ] Laptop & Charger (mandatory for hands-on hacking)
- [ ] Valid College / University Student ID Card
- [ ] Active GitHub account (ready to submit PRs)
- [ ] Joined the official WhatsApp group (for live event updates)
- [ ] Git installed on your laptop (we recommend this beforehand)
- [ ] Registration completed on MLH (required for the Attendee Kit)

VENUE & ATTENDEE LOGISTICS

GETTING THERE.

The event will take place on campus at Atria Institute of Technology in Hebbal, Bengaluru. High-speed Wi-Fi, power ports, lunch, and refreshments are provided.

ATRIA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

1st Main Road, AGS Colony, Anandnagar, Hebbal
Bengaluru, Karnataka 560024, India
13.032716° N, 77.591430° E

GOOGLE MAPS DIRECTIONS

ADD TO CALENDAR



CAMPUS WI-FI — CONNECT AFTER THE INAUGURATION

Your network credentials are handed out individually after the opening ceremony. Join **AIT_Students** with the password below, and you will be redirected to a sign-in page — enter the personal credentials given to you at the desk there to get online.

NETWORK	PASSWORD
AIT_Students	helloworld

FOOD & COUPONS

ONE SERVING EACH

12:45 - 01:30 PM

LUNCH

On campus. Hand in your **food coupon** at the counter to collect it.

05:00 - 05:30 PM

SNACKS & REFRESHMENTS

Drinks and snacks — hand in your **snack coupon** at the counter.

ONE SERVING EACH. THIS IS STRICT.

Each participant gets **one food coupon and one snack coupon**, redeemable only at the matching break. Hand the coupon in at the counter — and that is your serving. **There are no second servings**, and asking for one will mean going without. Please do not queue twice.



High-speed campus Wi-Fi network available throughout the venue.



Centrally located in Anandnagar, Hebbal with convenient bus and transit connectivity.



Aim to reach the venue by 8:15 AM — autos and cabs surge on event mornings, so leave early.

FRIDAY, 23 OCTOBER 2026

THE DAY ITSELF.

Be at the venue before 8:15 AM. Registration opens at 8:30 AM for check-in, and the day runs through the awards at 7:00 PM. Mentors and organizers will be on deck throughout to support every builder.

08:30 – 09:30	**Check-in & Registration**	Arrive before 8:15 AM. Teams check in together at one desk, and every participant is issued a wristband — keep it on for the rest of the day.
09:30 – 10:00	**Inauguration, Opening Ceremony & Hack Day Briefing**	Welcome from the AWS Student Builder Group and Atria faculty, then the tracks, rules, and judging criteria.
10:00 – 05:00	**Hack Day: Hacking & Building**	The main build window — pick a track, claim issues, and pair up with mentors on the floor. The trivia and meal breaks below fall inside it.
11:30 – 11:45	**Trivia 1**	A quick developer trivia break between commits — fifteen minutes, teams of up to four.
12:45 – 01:30	**Lunch Break**	Lunch is provided on campus. Step away, refuel, and swap project ideas with the room.
03:00 – 03:15	**Trivia 2**	Second round of trivia before the final push — same rules, harder questions.
05:00 – 05:30	**Snacks, Refreshments & Networking**	Drinks and snacks — plus open networking with mentors, peers, and organizers before judging.
05:30 – 06:30	**Judging & Project Evaluation**	Mentors and judges review demos, pull requests, and project write-ups against the track criteria.
06:30 – 07:00	**Awards & Closing Ceremony**	Winners announced, prizes and swags handed out, and a group photo before we wrap.

05:00 PM · SUBMISSIONS OPEN

Project submissions go through the **MLH challenges page**, which opens at 5:00 PM. That is when teams start submitting — there is no other way in.

05:30 PM · JUDGING STARTS

Judging begins at 5:30 PM sharp. A project that is not submitted by then cannot be evaluated, so submit before the window closes.

SUBMITTING WELL

Leave time for it: a public repo, a clear write-up, and a demo you can actually run. Lifting the public repo is not a submission.

CHALLENGE TRACKS

THREE WAYS TO BUILD.

Every project can qualify for the core Hacktoberfest challenge, and any project that also uses Gemma 4 or AWS can qualify for those too. One project can take more than one track. Mentors are on-site to help.

STEP 01

PICK A TRACK

Core Hacktoberfest, Gemma 4, or AWS. One project can qualify for more than one.

STEP 02

BUILD ALL DAY

Mentors from AWS Student Builder Group and open source roam the room from 10:15 AM.

STEP 03

DEMO AND SUBMIT

Push your repo, open your PR, and get your project on stage.

CORE HACKTOBERFEST CHALLENGE

BEST OPEN-SOURCE AI PROJECT

The main Hacktoberfest track, run at every Hack Day. Build an original project where open-source or open-weight AI does real work: an agent skill, an open-weight model, or a model harness. These are examples within one challenge, and you may combine them.

- Open-source or open-weight AI must be an important part of the project.
- Published in a public GitHub repository, under an open-source license.
- An agent skill must comply with the Agent Skill Open Standard.
- A model-harness entry needs an original implementation, or meaningful changes to an existing open-source harness.

The winning team is announced on stage; prizes are confirmed closer to the day.

GOOGLE PARTNER CHALLENGE

BEST USE OF GEMMA 4

Build with Gemma 4, Google's lightweight open-weights multimodal model, through the Gemini API. Text and images together, or a focused tool, or a fast prototype — your call.

- **Multimodal experience** — work with text and images to build an assistant that understands more of what users share.
- **Focused AI tools** — a tool for learning, creativity, productivity, or your community.
- **Rapid prototyping** — move quickly from an idea to a working prototype using an open model through the Gemini API.

The winning team is announced on stage; prizes are confirmed closer to the day.

AWS STUDENT BUILDER GROUP SPECIAL

BEST USE OF AWS

Our own bonus track for this Hack Day. Use the AWS ecosystem to turn an idea into something real and scalable. Any AWS service counts — pick whichever fits your project, and combining several is encouraged.

- **Cloud-powered solutions** — applications that are scalable, reliable, and ready for real-world use.
- **Innovative use of AWS** — combine services creatively to solve a meaningful problem in your community, on campus, or beyond.
- **Build and deploy** — go beyond a prototype by deploying on AWS and showing how the cloud powers your solution.

AWS services must be an important part of the project, with a clear explanation of how they contribute. The strongest AWS-powered build takes the track; prizes are confirmed closer to the day.

Team up beforehand, or meet someone during the morning and join their team. Solo builders are just as welcome. All experience levels welcome.

FULL CHALLENGE BRIEFS

Complete briefs, prize details, and judging notes live on the official MLH challenges page — including anything announced after this handbook went to print.

READ THE BRIEFS ON MLH

RECOGNITION & REWARDS

HOW TO WIN.

JUDGING & PROJECT EVALUATION

Mentors and judges review demos, pull requests, and project write-ups against the track criteria. The winning team is announced on stage, and prizes are confirmed closer to the day.

Every project can qualify for the core Hacktoberfest challenge, and any project that also uses Gemma 4 or AWS can qualify for those too.

KIT

ATTENDEE KIT

Check-in kit for registered attendees who show up and build. Contents are confirmed closer to the day.

REGISTERED ATTENDEES

BUILT

PARTICIPATION BADGE

A Hacktoberfest participation badge for everyone who shows up and builds on the day, whether or not your team places in a challenge.

EVERYONE WHO BUILDS

CERT

CERTIFICATE OF PARTICIPATION

A digital certificate of participation issued by AWS Student Builder Group at Atria Institute of Technology for every builder who completes the day.

FROM YOUR HOSTS

TRACK WINNERS

ANNOUNCED ON STAGE

- **Best Open-Source AI Project** — the Core Hacktoberfest track prize.
- **Best Use of Gemma 4** — the Google partner track prize.
- **Best Use of AWS** — the AWS Student Builder Group special.

HOW IT WORKS

BEFORE, DURING, OR AFTER THE DAY

1

YOUR PHOTO

Drop a photo in, or click to browse. JPG or PNG, under 8 MB.

2

YOUR FULL NAME

Up to 30 characters. Long names wrap to two lines on the ticket.

3

TAKE IT WITH YOU

Download the PNG, then share it to LinkedIn or your apps of choice.

MAKE YOUR BADGE NOW

Three fields and a download — no account, no sign-up. Do it before you arrive or between commits.

MAKE YOUR ATTENDEE BADGE

THE QUESTIONS WE GET MOST

FAQ.

Attending, registering, bringing, teams, beginners — and then the practical rules for the day itself.

Q1 WHO CAN ATTEND THIS HACK DAY?

All university and college students — beginners writing their first lines of code and experienced contributors alike.

Q2 IS THERE ANY REGISTRATION FEE?

No! The hack day, workshops, mentor guidance, food and swags are all free.

Q3 WHAT SHOULD I BRING TO THE EVENT?

Your laptop, charger, student ID, and a valid GitHub account. Install Git beforehand if you can.

Q4 CAN I PARTICIPATE INDIVIDUALLY OR DO I NEED A TEAM?

You can participate solo or in teams of up to 4 members. If you don't have a team yet, you can easily find teammates during the morning team formation session.

Q5 I AM A COMPLETE BEGINNER TO OPEN SOURCE. CAN I STILL JOIN?

Absolutely. Dedicated mentors will guide you through Git commands, finding good first issues, and submitting clean pull requests.

Q6 HOW DOES THE MLH REGISTRATION WORK?

Use any 'Register Now' button to reach the official MLH event page. Log in or create an account, answer the questions, and join the WhatsApp group for live announcements.

Q7 WHEN DO I NEED TO ARRIVE, AND HOW DOES CHECK-IN WORK?

Be at the venue before 8:15 AM; registration opens at 8:30 AM. If you are in a team, every member must be at the desk together — we cannot check people in one at a time.

Q8 WHY DO I NEED A WRISTBAND?

It is how we identify you as a participant. Without it you will not be considered for any activity, including prizes and food. If it comes off, get a replacement at the desk.

Q9 HOW DOES FOOD WORK DURING THE DAY?

You get one food coupon for lunch and one snack coupon for the evening break. Hand the matching coupon in at the counter to collect your serving. One serving each — there are no second servings, and this is strict.

Q10 HOW AND WHEN DO WE SUBMIT OUR PROJECT?

Submissions go through the MLH challenges page, which opens at 5:00 PM. Judging starts at 5:30 PM, so submit before then — an unsubmitted project cannot be evaluated.

Q11 HOW DO I CONNECT TO THE WI-FI?

After the inauguration you are given your credentials individually. Join the AIT_Students network with the password shown on page 04, then enter the personal sign-in details you were given at the desk.

STILL STUCK?

CONTACTS & CHALLENGES.

Organisers and mentors answer in the WhatsApp group, usually within the hour on event week. For registration issues, start with MLH.

FULL CHALLENGE BRIEFS

Anything announced after this handbook went to print — updated briefs, prize details, and judging notes — lives on the official MLH challenges page for this event.

CHALLENGES ON MLH

ORGANISER

Darshan B

Event Host & Lead Organizer

AWS Student Builder Group · Atria Institute of Technology

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WHERE TO ASK

WHATSAPP GROUP

Live event updates. The fastest way to reach a human.

MLH EVENT PAGE

Registration. Start here for anything registration-related.

MLH CODE OF CONDUCT

The standard everyone at the event agrees to.

Hacktoberfest Hack Day Bengaluru 2026 · AWS Student Builder Group at Atria Institute of Technology · Friday, 23 October 2026 · 8:30 AM onwards, Atria Institute of Technology, Hebbal.

REGISTER ON MLH

BUILT BY COMMUNITY

Every contribution matters, whether it is a first bug fix or an entire package.

OPEN-WEIGHT MODELS

Build with Gemma 4, the open SKILL.md agent standard, and model harnesses.

FREE FOOD, SWAG & KITS

The day is free for students. Lunch, snacks, stickers and swag worth over ₹1.4 Lakh.

AWS STUDENT BUILDER GROUP

Our student-led group at Atria IT, running hands-on builder hack days in cloud and AI.